* Dashboard in Excel :- An Excel Dashboard is a visual representation of important business data in one place. It combines charts, tables, Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) and Interactive filters to help users understand business performance and make data-driven decisions.

(*) Objectives of an Excel Dashboard :-

- To present large amounts of data in a simple, visual format.
- To monitor important business metrics.
- To compare sales and profit across products and locations.

- To identify trends and patterns over time.
- To filter data interactively using slicers and timelines.
- To support faster and better business decisions.

(*) Steps to Create an Excel Dashboard :-

1. Prepare the source data.
2. Convert the data into an Excel Table.
3. Create Pivot Tables.
4. Create charts from the Pivot Tables.
5. Create KPI cards.
6. Add Slicers.
7. Add a timeline.
8. Connect slicers and timelines.
9. Arrange the dashboard layout.
10. Test and refresh the dashboard.

(*) Why Use Excel Dashboards When PowerBI Is Available ?

Excel & PowerBI both support data analysis and visualization, but they are useful in different situations.

Excel	PowerBI
○ Excellent for calculations, formulas and spreadsheet-based analysis.	○ Excellent for interactive reports and advanced dashboards.
○ Suitable for quick analysis & smaller projects.	○ Suitable for larger models & reports involving multiple data sources.

◦ Familiar and widely used in everyday business tasks.	◦ Offers strong report-sharing & publishing capabalities.
◦ PivotTables, Pivotcharts, Slicers, and timelines support interactive analysis.	◦ Supports rich interactive visuals, drill-downs, and report filters.
◦ Useful for ad hoc analysis & financial or operational reporting.	◦ Useful for recurring business intelligence reports & organizational monitoring.

(*) Why learn Excel Charts?

- Many Organizations still use Excel for day-to-day reporting.
- Excel is useful for quickly exploring data before building a report in Power BI.
- PivotTables & Pivotcharts help summarize data without writing complex code.
- Excel skills are valuable for data cleaning, calculations & initial exploratory analysis.
- Learning Excel builds a strong foundation for Power BI & other analytics tools.

Excel is not a replacement for Power BI in every situation, and Power BI is not required for every report.

(*) Important Terms :-

- Pivot Table ⇒ Summarizes & analyzes data.
- Pivot Chart ⇒ Visualizes data summarized by a Pivot Table.
- KPI ⇒ A measurable indicator used to track performance against a goal.
- Slicer ⇒ An interactive visual filter for Pivot Tables & Connected reports.
- Timeline ⇒ An interactive filter specifically designed for date fields.
- Dashboard ⇒ A single view combining important metrics and visualizations.
- Data-driven decision-making ⇒ Using data and analysis to guide business decisions.